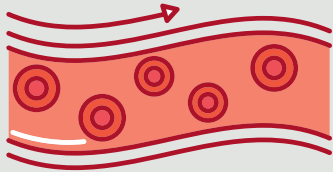


Treating High Blood Pressure in People with Diabetes

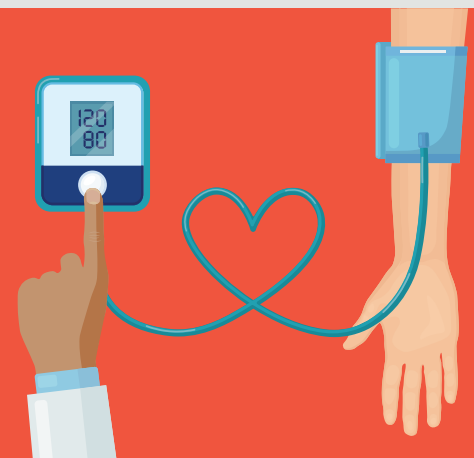


Blood pressure is the force of blood inside your blood vessels. When your blood pressure is high, your heart has to work harder.

Know Your Numbers

Blood pressure above your target range raises your risk for heart attack and stroke, even if you feel fine.

Talk with your healthcare team about your blood pressure goal and how often to check it. Most adults should have their blood pressure checked at least once a year at a healthcare visit.



Understanding Your Blood Pressure Goal

The blood pressure goal for most people living with diabetes is below **130/80 mmHg**. If you're at higher risk for heart disease, your doctor may have you aim for a goal of below 120/80 mmHg.

Possible Symptoms

You may not have symptoms if your blood pressure is high, which is why checking it is so important. When your blood pressure gets very high, you may notice symptoms such as:



headaches



nosebleeds



feeling
weak



blurry
vision



chest
pain

Ways to Manage Your Blood Pressure



Small daily actions that can help lower blood pressure include:

- Following an eating plan based on the DASH, low-carb, or very low-carb eating patterns
- Choosing foods with less sodium
- Getting regular physical activity
- Limiting alcohol, if you choose to drink

Talk to your healthcare team about what changes to your treatment plan can help you reach your blood pressure goal.

